

Kristen McDaniel

Lithonia, GA 30058 • (678) 330-9344 • Kmcdaniel@MSM.edu • [LinkedIn](#)

EDUCATION

- **Morehouse School of Medicine**, Atlanta, GA May 2027
Master of Public Health, GPA: 3.8
 - **Howard University**, Washington, D.C. May 2025
Bachelor of Science in Biology, Chemistry minor, GPA: 3.4
-

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCES

Illinois Department of Public Health, Springfield, IL August 2026 - Present

Public Health Data and Policy Intern

- Analyze healthcare access and population health data across Illinois.
- Contribute to a statewide report on patient access to care and health outcomes.
- Apply epidemiologic and data analysis methods to identify health disparities.
- Use data-driven findings to inform health policy and decision-making.
- Translate analyses into actionable insights for policymakers and public health stakeholders.

Visionworks, Lithonia, GA August 2025 - Present

Clinical Specialist

- Conduct clinical pre-testing and assisting optometrists with comprehensive eye examinations while ensuring meticulous Electronic Health Record (EHR) documentation.
- Manage patient scheduling, insurance verification workflows, and front desk administrative operations.
- Advise patients on customized eyewear solutions, provided clinical instruction on contact lens insertion and care, and maintained strict HIPAA compliance regarding protected health information.

Lowery Institute, Atlanta, GA

August 2023 - May 2025

Undergraduate Research Intern

- Clark Atlanta University, 2024-2025 Team Leader
- Research: “The Student Nutrition and Access Reform Act”
- Translated public health findings into formal legislative action by drafting a targeted policy bill aimed at reforming food access and nutrition programs for marginalized student populations.
- Managed team milestones, coordinated literature reviews, and synthesized complex demographic data to advocate for health equity interventions.

NexploreUSA, Atlanta, GA

May 2025 - July 2025

Stem Instructor

- Usher-Collier Elementary
- Facilitated hands-on STEM lessons to Pre-K through 5th grade
- Ensured effective implementation and student engagement through hands on learning

H&M Hennes & Mauritz AB, Frederick, MD

May 2022 - July 2022

Retail Associate

- Provided excellent customer service by assisting shoppers
- Maintained store appearance through merchandising, restocking, and keeping fitting rooms and sales floors organized
- Operated the cash register, process transactions, and handle returns or exchanges efficiently

AWARDS/SCHOLARSHIPS

- 2026 Crowned for a Cause Scholarship Recipient
- 2025 Morehouse School of Medicine, Friends of VMR Scholarship Recipient
- 2024 Wells Fargo Access Scholarship Recipient
- 2024 Rosa A. Wilson Scholarship Recipient
- 2024 Dr. Kathryn Kelly Scholarship Recipient
- 2024 Juanita Robinson English Book Scholarship Recipient

- 2023 - 2025 CVS Health Foundation Health Care Careers Scholarship Recipient
-

ACADEMIC PROJECTS

Morehouse School of Medicine

Atlanta, GA

Identifying Breast Cancer Screening and Prevention Barriers for Black women in the United States and Potential Culturally Tailored Interventions to Reduce Mortality Rates

April 2026

- Drafted a secondary analysis research proposal to analyze multi-level barriers to breast cancer screening and prevention among Black women in the United States.
- Proposal planned to synthesize clinical and behavioral data from the Behavioral Risk Factor Surveillance System (BRFSS) alongside contemporary 2024-2025 literature to evaluate the impact of medical mistrust and systemic policy gaps on health outcomes.
- Identified specific opportunities for culturally tailored interventions to reduce the disproportionate mortality rate among Black women under age 40.

Examining the Association Between Age, Sleep Duration, and Cholesterol Levels in Relation to Cardiovascular Health

April 2026

- Applied a cross-sectional analysis to examine the association between age, sleep duration, and total cholesterol levels as modifiable risk factors for cardiovascular disease.
- Synthesized nationally representative epidemiologic data from the National Health and Nutrition Examination Survey (NHANES), analyzing a sample of 7,326 observations using R-based multiple linear regression.
- Evaluated the predictive power of age and sleep duration on cholesterol levels, identifying age as a robust predictor ($p < 0.001$) while determining that sleep duration alone requires a more holistic, multi-variable approach for accurate risk assessment.

NPU-K Community Health Promotion Intervention Plan: Residential Redevelopment & Reinvestment Plan

April 2026

- Applied a community-based health promotion framework to address housing instability and environmental health risks in Atlanta's NPU-K historically marginalized neighborhoods.
- +1
- Synthesized qualitative and quantitative community data to identify critical health determinants, including mold exposure, lead, and limited green space access, contributing to chronic disease and asthma.

- Evaluated evidence-based housing repair and outreach strategies to design a \$560,000 intervention plan focused on stabilizing housing quality and improving long-term health outcomes for residents.

EPOA Framework Application for Influenza and Pneumonia

October 2025

- Applied the Epidemiologic Problem-Oriented Approach (EPOA) to analyze influenza and pneumonia by characterizing disease determinants and evaluating prevention and control strategies.
- Synthesized epidemiologic data from CDC, WHO, PubMed, and Galileo to assess morbidity, mortality, and contributing factors (2015–2025).
- Evaluated evidence-based interventions, including vaccination and public health education, to identify gaps and opportunities for improved disease prevention and control in the United States.

The Effect of Environmental Conditions on the Accumulation of Strontium in Public Water Sources

November 2025

- Conducted a mock environmental exposure study assessing strontium concentrations in five public water sources across two watershed regions.
- Utilized SAS 9.4 to perform one-way ANOVA and Tukey HSD post hoc analyses, testing between- and within-group variability to identify statistically significant differences among water sources.

Structural Bias and its Prevalence in Nation's Capitol: Washington, D.C.

September 2025

- Authored a policy-focused public health analysis examining structural bias and its impact on health, education, and socioeconomic disparities in Washington, D.C. Synthesized demographic, epidemiologic, and policy data to assess the role of historical redlining and systemic inequities in shaping HIV/AIDS prevalence and neighborhood-level health outcomes.
- Applied social determinants of health and structural racism frameworks to identify targeted prevention, intervention, and policy reform strategies.

Windshield Survey Community Assessment

November 2025

- Conducted a windshield community assessment of NPU-K (Bankhead), Atlanta, evaluating built environment, demographics, transportation, services, and health-related stressors.
- Analyzed neighborhood conditions including aging infrastructure, housing instability, limited healthcare access, and environmental exposures to identify implications for chronic disease risk and health equity.
- Synthesized observational data and secondary sources to highlight community assets, resilience, and opportunities for equitable public health intervention.

COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

Morehouse School of Medicine, Atlanta, GA

August 2025 - Present

- o H.E.A.L. Clinic: Assists with patient intake by recording vital signs and updating medical histories. Support clinic staff with administrative tasks, maintaining a clean and organized environment to ensure efficient patient care.

Howard University, Washington D.C.

August 2021 – May 2025

- o Student Volunteer, Northstar Tutoring: Assists 4th and 5th grade students in marginalized communities with english and math
- o Active Member, Tau Beta Sigma:
 - Stem Global Action (2024): Assisted in planning and publicity for the event and helped facilitate STEM activities for over 100 K-8 students.
 - Voter Registration Drive (2024): Supported planning, tabling, and publicity for a to assist students with voting in the 2024 election.
 - Fine Arts Cleanup (2023/2024): Volunteered in room cleanouts for Fine Arts to improve student spaces.
 - NOURISH HU Food Pantry Donation Drive: (2024): Spearheaded as team leader, combining health policy research with a service project addressing campus food insecurity.
 - Feminine Care Product Drive (2024): Collected feminine care products in collaboration with Kappa Kappa Psi for donation to DC-area shelters.
 - Adopt a Family Initiative (2023/2024): Organized and managed a calendar fundraiser for the; purchased and wrapped holiday gifts for families in need.
 - Freshmen Move In: Assisted incoming freshmen students moving into their dormitories
- o Pontiac Alumnae Chapter of Delta Sigma Theta Sorority, Incorporated:
 - Student Panelist for Virtual Scholarship and College Forum - HBCU

LEADERSHIP/INVOLVEMENT

Historian Chair

Morehouse School of Medicine MPH Student Government Association

May 2026 - Present

Historian Vice Chair

Morehouse School of Medicine MPH Student Government Association

September 2025 - May 2026

- Document and organize MPHSGA activities, media, and records throughout the year.
- Assist with social media updates, photography, and scrapbook creation.
- Support the Historian and Secretary with administrative and archival tasks.

MPH Biostatistics Tutor

Morehouse School of Medicine

June 2026 - Present

- Provide individualized support with statistical calculations, study design, hypothesis testing, and regression analysis.
- Assist students with statistical software and data analysis, including R and SAS.
- Break down complex quantitative concepts into clear, accessible explanations to strengthen students' analytical skills.

Colorguard Coach

Campbell High School Marching Band

May 2026 - Present

- Coach and mentor color guard students in flag technique, choreography, performance, and teamwork.
- Develop and lead practices focused on skill development, conditioning, and performance readiness.
- Provide individualized feedback to help students improve technique, confidence, and stage presence.
- Collaborate with directors and staff to prepare students for performances, competitions, and community events.

Historian

Howard University Eta Delta Chapter of Tau Beta Sigma National Honorary Band Sorority, Incorporated

May 2023 - May 2025

- Promoted the existence and welfare of the Howard University Band Program
- Created a safe space for band members to grow and flourish as individuals and musicians

- Maintained Chapter history and regulated social media pages

Captain,

Howard University Flashy Flag Squad of the S.H.O.W.T.I.M.E. Marching Band

April 2023 - May 2025

- Provided instruction and planned logistics
- Served as a band ambassador for University collaborations and promotions

Second Vice President and Secretary,

Howard University Council of Independent Organizations

September 2023 - May 2025

- Planned and hosted events for the Council and Howard students
- Records minutes and attendance of council meetings

Founder and President,

Howard University One of a Kind

May 2022 - May 2023

- 1st Korean Pop Dance Team hosted at an Historically Black College/University

PRESENTATIONS

- McDaniel, K., Kikuchi, K., Potter, L., & Hall, M. (August 2024). Community engagement strategies that connect communities and researchers to address persistent poverty and its effects on cancer risk. Huntsman Cancer Institute, University of Utah.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

The Los Angeles Biostatistics and Data Science Summer Training Program at USC

June – July 2026

University of Southern California, Keck School of Medicine, Department of Population and Public Health Sciences

- University of Southern California, Department of Population and Public Health Sciences
- Research: “Heat Exposure and Emergency Department Visits in New York City: Association and Prediction of Heat-Related Health Outcomes”
- Constructed a Quasi-Poisson regression model to quantify the relationship between daily maximum temperatures (sourced from LaGuardia Airport) and heat-related emergency department visits.
- Developed predictive modeling frameworks to project future emergency department spikes for the 2026 season and compared predicted values against actual observed data.

The 5 for the Fight Cancer Research Program

May 2024 - August 2024

Huntsman Cancer Institute Undergraduate Research Intern

- University of Utah, Center for Health Outcomes and Population Equity
- Research: “Community Engagement Strategies that Connect Communities and Researchers to Address Persistent Poverty and its Effects of Cancer Risk”
- Synthesized epidemiological literature and population data to support development of evidence-based intervention strategies targeting cancer risk factors in low-income areas.
- Collaborated with research assistants to execute study protocols, manage project databases, and facilitate the translation of academic research into actionable public health outreach.

ADDITIONAL SKILLS

Computer

- Microsoft Office Suite (Word, PowerPoint, Access, Excel) & Social Media

Research

- Data entry and management & Analysis (SAS, R Studio, Python, Qualtrics, REDCap)

Certifications

- Collaborative Institution Training Initiative (CITI)